

3.8 Webcams

Webcams are important communication accessories that are used in conjunction with chatting on the Net. A few terms associated with webcams are discussed next.



A webcam

3.8.1 Actual Resolution

This is the actual number of pixels that the camera CCD can capture. This is expressed in pixels (or megapixels).

3.8.2 AVI

Audio Video Interlace is a method for storing these two data streams by interleaving them. AVI is a popular file format. Webcams can be used to record video data which is stored in AVI format.

3.8.3 CCD

Charge Coupled Devices are optical sensors that are needed to convert the optical data into electrical impulses. These can be coloured to capture data related to each colour in the RGB scheme (Red, Green, Blue).

3.8.4 Compression

Uncompressed Video data is quite data intensive, and for transferring this data over the net one would need very high speed internet connections. Compressing the video streams reduced the file size, without causes any significant loss in quality. Different webcams use different codecs to compress the video.

3.8.5 FPS

Frames per second refers to the frequency with which the webcam updates the CCD. A high refresh rate means that the captured motion is smoother. Most webcams capture at speeds of 25 fps.